James Villanueva

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Education

University of California, San Diego Sep. 2024 – June 2028
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *La Jolla, CA*
GPA: 3.6

- **Relevant Coursework:** Software Engineering, Data Structures and Object-Oriented Programming, Software Tools and Techniques, Discrete Mathematics, Computer Organization, Systems Programming, Algorithms
- Minor in Spanish Literature
- Member of ColorStack and Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE)

Experience

Software Engineering Team Lead Mar. 2026 – Jun. 2026
UCSD *California*

- Led a team of 11 through full-cycle design and development of a custom software application, coordinating architecture decisions, sprint priorities, and feature planning.
- Implemented application features, debugged issues during testing cycles, and collaborated with teammates to improve code quality and project consistency.
- Led frontend development, including UI design, wireframing, pull request reviews, and team communication to keep implementation aligned with project goals.

AI Conversation Simulation Research Assistant Mar. 2026 – Present
NSF-Funded Research, PI Dr. Kristen Vaccaro *UCSD*

- Built automated evaluation infrastructure for a multi-agent classroom discussion simulator, including an LLM-as-judge pipeline and a HuggingFace transformer-based stance classifier to score agent conversations at scale.
- Designed experimental stimuli and study scope, reviewing prior literature to select research questions and defining the agent persona/voice set used as a core experimental variable.
- Developed evaluation metrics across turn-taking length, coherence, lexical diversity, stance, and persona consistency for a FastAPI/Next.js system modeling multi-agent conversation.

Projects

Club Connector | *TypeScript, React, Node.js, Next.js* January 2026 – Present

- Developing a full-stack web application to help students discover and join campus organizations through a searchable, student-focused interface.
- Implementing dynamic frontend components using Next.js and React while coordinating with teammates through Git-based workflows and code reviews.

WatchTower | *JavaScript, Node.js, Supabase/Postgres, Clerk, Jest, Playwright* April 2026 – June 2026

- Engineered an observability tool in an 11-person team using Agile methodologies, Git-based version control, and structured code review processes.
- Built a full-stack platform with a browser SDK, authenticated dashboard, backend event ingestion, and database-backed telemetry storage for application monitoring.

Certifications

CodePath AI Engineering Certificate

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python, C/C++, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, ARM assembly, LaTeX
Frameworks: React, Next.js, Node.js
Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Vim, Bash, Supabase/Postgres, Clerk, Playwright, OpenAI API
Professional Skills: Team leadership, code review, technical communication, debugging, collaboration, project planning